

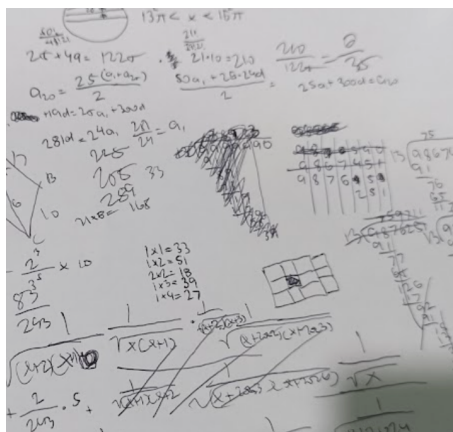
Hi! It seems you want some test taking tips. Admittedly, I don't claim to know the best tips, but I am sure I can offer some advice. For the days before the contest:

- Relax and stay calm. Forget what happened in contests before, this is a new day and new opportunity to do better.
- Don't get stuck on the order. Feel free to skip if the problem looks too bashy or is from a topic which you are weaker in. Come back to those problems later if/when you have time. Don't get this mindset "it is only problem #3 and this should be easy"
- Budget your time wisely. You likely know what an approximate plan for yourself should be having done some practice tests. Try to develop this plan for yourself, but this doesn't necessarily mean stick with it the whole way through. In test, you should be able to adapt to the problems you are given.
- Save a few minutes to double check if you have bubbled your answers correctly, and you have marked every problem you've solved
- Learn about things regarding the year. 2025 has some special properties – it is a perfect square! I am sure it has more, but it is good to know its prime factorization and some other stuff.

For the day of the contest, get some good sleep. Maybe pack a snack and water since 3 hours is a long time. Although, I'm not sure if snacks are allowed. Make sure to adapt to the contest and enjoy the problems. Three hours is a lot of time for you to experiment with the problems and get a good attempt at them. Just because it seems hard at first glance doesn't mean that repetitively attacking the problem will still make it a tough problem to attempt.

As you go through the contest, make sure to scratch paper is neat and organized. Here are some tips to do so:

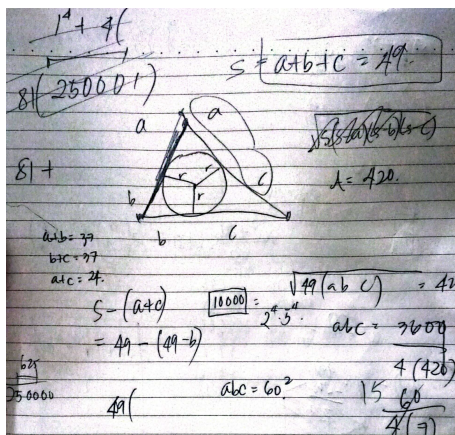
- When you attempt a problem, label it. If you decide to go back and double check your work, then you know exactly where to find it. Here is a picture of scratch work with problems all over. It is unclear where the problems are. Maybe one could decipher it, but that takes far more work than necessary. When you take a contest, you want to the process of checking your answers to be as seamless as possible.



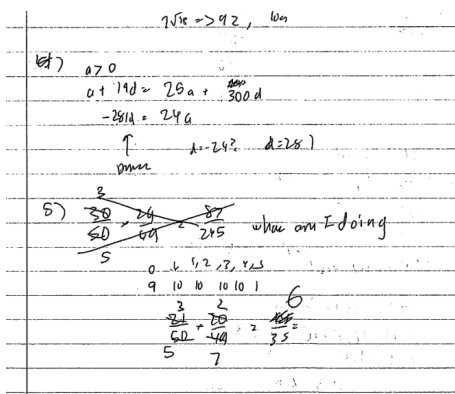


the attempts. It is a bit messy in terms of handwriting, but the contestant clearly makes a goal of organizing attempts.

- Finally, give yourself enough space to work on the problem. Don't make your work so cramped and don't limit the space in which you solve the problem.



Below is a nice example where problems are clearly distinguished. The above paper is scattered and seems like the contestant just wanted to write all the scratch on one piece of paper.



Here are some [good examples](#) of work from some friends and the amazing Evan Chen. Mine gets a bit messy at the end, but the early sections are fairly well organized.

One of the benefits to having three hours to work on PMO means there is an abundant amount of time. Taking a few extra seconds to make your handwriting better will definitely do wonders. It will take away from making any silly mistakes. Some credibility: over the last four AMCs I have participated in, I simply write neatly and clearly. Although I have never checked my answers once, I have only made a mistake on three problems from what I answered (tbh, ignoring the last exam because I was trolling, I have only made one mistake).

I wish everyone the best of luck and hopefully you can take away a few things from this document. You most likely have all the knowledge of theorems that will appear on the test, you just need to figure out what to apply and how.